



See the hunger coming — and act in time.

Fill the granary before the drought.

The first Zimbabwean-owned food-security foresight engine. Hoji forecasts where hunger is heading, district by district, then helps planners **get the most from the resources they already have** — so early action reaches the right places in time. Sovereign, open, and built at home.

Submitted by

Curious Inq — AI-powered creative studio, Harare
Nash Barara · Product & Design Lead | [Technical Lead] | [Food-Security Advisor]

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Zimbabwe
Open-source · built locally

THE PROBLEM

We see the hunger coming. We just see it too late to act in time.

Almost every year, parts of Zimbabwe slide into food shortage when the rains fail and harvests fall short. The tragedy is rarely that no one saw it coming. It is that the warning arrives too late, buried in slow seasonal reports produced outside the country — after the season is already lost and the moment for early action has passed.

Planners are then left to stretch limited resources across many struggling districts with no quick, shared way to see where action would do the most good. The result is help that arrives late, and in the wrong order.

THE SOLUTION

Hози — from early warning to a ready plan.

Hози does two things no seasonal report does. First, it **forecasts** where food risk is heading over the next one to three months, for every district. Then it helps responders **plan**: enter the resources already set aside, and Hози shows where that effort protects the most people and hectares — so existing budgets go further.

WHO IT IS FOR — AND HOW IT RESPECTS THEIR AUTHORITY

Hози is a decision-support tool for the people who plan the response — the Ministry of Lands & Agriculture, food-security and civil-protection officers, ZimVAC, and relief NGOs. **It supports existing decision-makers and processes; it informs, it does not decide or override.** Hози never sets budgets and never tells government how to spend. The planner is always in control.

HOW IT WORKS — FIVE CLEAR STEPS

1

Read signals

Rainfall, vegetation, pests, irrigation & input access, district by district.

2

Score risk

A transparent, explainable food-security risk score (0–100) per district.

3

Look ahead

Project the trend 1–3 months forward with an honest confidence range.

4

Test plans

Enter existing resources and compare where they protect the most people.

5

Explain

Plain-language alerts on a clear map, in English & local languages.

In one line: the world's tools tell Zimbabwe what will happen. Hози helps our own responders **act on it in time, with the resources they already have** — interactively, and ours.

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

A transparent engine — not a black box.

HOW IT IS BUILT

- **Data layer:** district climate, crop & market signals (rainfall, NDVI vegetation, pests, irrigation, input access, prices, yields).
- **Risk engine:** a clear weighted model giving a 0–100 food-security risk per district.
- **Forecast:** seasonal trend projection 1–3 months ahead, with a widening confidence band.
- **Response planner:** for a given level of resources, ranks where action reduces the most risk.
- **Interface:** a web map — time-slider, district drill-down, what-if planner — on a normal browser.

PROVEN AGAINST THE DATA

0.81

MATCH BETWEEN HOZI'S RISK SCORE AND AN INDEPENDENT AGRICULTURAL RISK INDEX

A strong match means the model reflects real conditions — it is not guessing. From there, Hozì projects the same well-understood seasonal trend forward and is honest about uncertainty.

THE FEATURE THAT SETS HOZI APART

The Response Planner — make every committed dollar count

Enter the resources already allocated for the season and Hozì shows where that effort protects the most people per dollar, and in what order. Global tools forecast hunger; Hozì helps our own responders turn an existing budget into the most lives protected — without ever setting that budget.

INNOVATIVE FEATURES

From warning to a plan.

It turns a forecast into a fundable, comparable response.

Sovereign & open.

The first Zimbabwean-owned food-security engine — open-source, not a foreign black box.

Speaks our languages.

Early-warning briefs in English, chiShona & isiNdebele for the last mile.

Honest by design.

It shows its workings and states what it cannot know — trust over overclaiming.

Locally fed.

District officers can report ground truth that foreign satellites cannot see.

One engine, many hazards.

The same system extends to floods and disease — a national disaster-warning seed.

Responsible AI: Hozì is decision-support, not an oracle. It keeps a human expert in the loop, shows its reasoning, and is honest about uncertainty — in line with the ethics of the National AI Strategy.

PROJECTED BENEFITS

Every \$1 of early action saves \$7. Hozì helps find it in time.

The World Food Programme estimates anticipatory action returns at least seven-to-one. The hard part is acting early and in the right order. In a working test on national sample data, Hozì flagged a sharp seasonal rise in risk and showed where existing effort would pay off most.

0 → 19

DISTRICTS (OF 20) PROJECTED INTO HIGH RISK BY SEPTEMBER WITHOUT EARLY ACTION

7×

RETURN ON EVERY DOLLAR OF TIMELY, WELL-TARGETED EARLY ACTION (WFP)

3 mo.

EARLIER WARNING THAN A TYPICAL SEASONAL REPORT CYCLE

- **Fewer hungry families:** seed, irrigation and relief move *before* the harvest fails, not after.
- **Existing budgets go further:** the same resources are guided to where they cut the most risk.
- **One shared truth:** ministries, NGOs and donors plan from the same live picture, not competing reports.

NATIONAL ALIGNMENT

HOW HOZI ADVANCES THE NATIONAL AI STRATEGY

- Delivers the Strategy's **Year-1 Food Security** priority.
- Builds the "**AI disaster-warning system**" the Strategy explicitly calls for.
- Supports **Pillar 3** (AI for service delivery & decision-making).
- An analytics layer for the national data platform (**Project Pangolin**).
- Embodies **sovereignty, local language & responsible AI**.

WHY US

A RARE BLEND

Curious Inq pairs senior design and storytelling with applied AI. Most technical entries are powerful but unreadable; most beautiful ones are thin. Hozi is both — a serious engine a Minister can understand in thirty seconds.

Stage	Owner
Product, design, narrative	Nash Barara
Engine & deployment	[Technical Lead]
Domain validation	[Food-Security Advisor]

ROADMAP

Now: working engine + national map + response planner on sample data. **3 months:** live rainfall/satellite feeds, all staple crops, pilot with one ministry or NGO. **12 months:** national roll-out, local-language alerts to district officers, multi-hazard expansion, integration with Project Pangolin.

Hozi does not replace the experts, and it does not set budgets. It gives our own planners a head start — turning scattered numbers into a clear plan, early enough to act, so fewer families go hungry.